

SAWYERS FORTUNE

Written By

CJ BRAINARD

EXT HIGH SCHOOL-Late Afternoon

Emma is standing with Sawyer outside the school

EMMA

It's really hot, can we go now?

SAWYER

Just give them 2 more minutes

EMMA

Why can't we just go alone?

SAWYER

We need backup

EMMA

You do know that normal couples go on dates to restaurants or museums?

SAWYER

Other couples also have jobs and money. We don't. Besides-

Sawyer is interrupted by 2 other boys who appear in front of the school

EDDIE

Is today the big day?

CHARLES

Yeah you finally gonna get into Franklin's dungeon?

EMMA

Franklins dungeon !??

SAWYER

Relax, it's just what they call the old military building by the creek. Nothing scary at all.

EMMA ROLLS HER EYES

The 4 set off walking away from the school towards the old building

EXT CREEK-LATE AFTERNOON

CHARLES

I threw up in this creek once

SAWYER  
Emma might be next

They laugh

EMMA  
You too are so weird. And this creek  
smells bad.

CHARLES  
Its not that bad. At least water stops  
flowing through this time of year

Just as Charles says that Emma steps  
in a soft part of the grass in the  
creek and her foot squelches into mud.

EMMA  
Ugh!! Thats so gross are we almost  
there?

SAWYER  
Yes. Just look up

They look above the creek walls and see the edges of a  
desolate, boarded up building at the top of the hill.

EDDIE  
Now time for the fun bit

EMMA  
Whats that?

SAWYER  
Climbing up that hill!

Sawyer immediately takes off running. The excitement of  
finally entering Franklins dungeon rampant. The other 3  
follow behind

EXT FRANKLINS DUNGEON-DAYTIME

Everyone climbed the hill and are out of air. They stand at  
the front of the building and marvel at the sight

EDDIE  
Say Sawyer, why haven't you been in  
before? I mean you live close to it  
and go to school close to it.

SAWYER

My dad works for the police remember,  
he would've killed me. But hey, I'm 18  
next week, I'm basically a man.

EMMA

I agree with your dad

CHARLES

Yeah it's even dirtier than when I  
don't clean my room

SAWYER

Impossible

EMMA

This is a waste of time

SAWYER

What if there's treasure

CHARLES

Now thats impossible

They chuckle then stare at the array of trash in front of a  
grey box-shape structure. 3 stories of broken windows and  
grafiti.

SAWYER

Well, time to strike while the iron's  
hot as they say.

Sawyer heads towards the corner of the building and crouches  
down

SAWYER

I heard someone dug a hole behind one  
of these bushes. That should lead us  
in

EMMA

And maybe never out

EDDIE

Someone should probably stay on watch,  
ya'know, just in case. I can do that

SAWYER

Or how about first one inside wins and  
everyone else sucks

Sawyer suddenly slides into a hole under the foundation of the concrete box. A crashing noise is heard

CHARLES

Sounds like someone has fallen and  
can't get back up

EMMA

Would you just shut up he might hurt!

SAWYER

Don't worry guys!! I landed on a  
window. Just didn't expect there to be  
one on the ground

EDDIE

This man almost died before he even  
started exploring

CHARLES

I'm next

Charles slides through the foundation landing on dusty  
linoleum floor. Sawyer is kicking glass out of the way from  
where he fell.

CHARLES

Wow this place is awesome!!

SAWYER

A beauty

They look around at the dusty basement. Old file boxes  
scattered all over the room. Dark, dingy, and musty. Suddenly  
they hear a yelp followed by another thud

SAWYER

What are you doing baby??

Emma stands up and dusts herself off

EMMA

If my boyfriend dies in an old  
military dump, I want to be there when  
it happens

SAWYER

Wow what an honor

EMMA

But be nice to me or I am finding the

first exit available in this filthy  
place and joining Eddie on look out

SAWYER  
I can make that happen

They kiss

CHARLES  
Ew get a room

EMMA AND SAWYER TOGETHER  
Shut the fuck up Charles

The 3 start searching the basement for a staircase

EMMA  
If the whole place looks like this we  
should just leave

CHARLES  
Yeah man, it's so dark in here

SAWYER  
That's why I brought this.

Sawyer produces a miniature flashlight from his pocket and  
begins pointing it around. The group walks down a long  
hallway

SAWYER  
I think I see something

CHARLES  
More trash?

SAWYER  
No I think it might be stairs

Sawyer walks towards wooden plank stairs

EMMA  
Legend says, if you step on those  
stairs you will fall through and die

SAWYER  
There's something good upstairs. I  
feel it

EMMA  
Yeah like maybe a door or something

Sawyer begins walking up the stairs with minimal worry or caution and the stairs immediately begin making a creak noise

EMMA

Okay its confirmed. Those stairs are not legit at all

CHARLES

Yeah better luck just going to a graveyard

EMMA

Yeah or maybe a landfill

Charles and Emma begin laughing when Sawyer suddenly falls through the stairs creating a giant crashing noise. Everyone starts screaming. Eddie peeps through the foundation entry hole and calls out

EDDIE

Everything ok down there?

EMMA

No!! Sawyer just fell. Is he ok??? Oh god call an ambulance. I knew this was a bad idea

EDDIE

Stay calm I'm coming down

Sawyer begins speaking from the rubble. His voice hoarse

SAWYER

Guys I'm ok

Emma runs over to the pile and puts her arms around Sawyer

EMMA

Are you sure, you might have a concussion!!

SAWYER

I don't think so. I think I have something better

He pull a plastic ziploc from the rubble and opens

CHARLES

Is that?

EMMA

No way

SAWYER

\$200

CHARLES

Someone's gonna want you dead

SAWYER

No that's just it!! don't you see. Its cash they'll never find us. Emma we can finally go to museums and restaurants

EDDIE

What happened??

CHARLES

Sawyer found \$200. Finders keepers

Sawyer stands up and dusts himself off

SAWYER

Maybe upstairs wasn't meant to be

They laugh and the screen goes black a